

Economic History II

Leaders, heroic networks and political values

FGV EPGE

Outline of the class

- Two papers, treated separately, on what a **network of leaders** does to political behavior.
- Assigned: Cagé, Grosjean and Jha, *The Influence of Heroic Networks*. Behind it, the full study: Cagé, Dagorret, Grosjean and Jha (2023), *Heroes and Villains*, AER.
- Alongside: Dippel and Heblich (2021), *Leadership in Social Movements*, AER.
- One network campaigns against slavery. The other legitimizes collaboration with Nazi Germany.

The “Forty-Eighters”

Dippel and Heblich (2021), *Leadership in Social Movements:
Evidence from the “Forty-Eighters” in the Civil War*

The enlistment puzzle

- US Civil War, 1861 to 1865. One in five adult men in the North took up arms: 2.2 million in the Union Army.
- 620,000 men died, as many as in all other American wars combined.
- A private earned about 13 dollars per month, less than a farmhand, and payment was irregular.
- Yet almost **95 percent of Northern soldiers were volunteers.**
- What did local leaders contribute to that decision?

Leadership in Social Movements: Evidence from the “Forty-Eighters” in the Civil War[†]

By CHRISTIAN DIPPEL AND STEPHAN HEBLICH*

This paper studies the role of leaders in the social movement against slavery that culminated in the US Civil War. Our analysis is organized around a natural experiment: leaders of the failed German revolution of 1848–1849 were expelled to the United States and became antislavery campaigners who helped mobilize Union Army volunteers. Towns where Forty-Eighters settled show two-thirds higher Union Army enlistments. Their influence worked through local newspapers and social clubs. Going beyond enlistment decisions, Forty-Eighters reduced their companies’ desertion rate during the war. In the long run, Forty-Eighter towns were more likely to form a local chapter of the NAACP. (JEL D74, J15, J45, J61, N31, N41)

Who the Forty-Eighters were

- Leaders of the German revolutions of 1848 and 1849.
- Wittke's definition: those “who in some way actually participated in the liberal movements and the Revolutions of 1848 and 1849, and left their homes because of a conflict with the established authorities.”
- What they had fought for in Europe: **liberty, democracy, national unity**.
- Almost 500 of them, traced through published biographies and genealogical records.

The expulsion

- The revolutions failed by the summer of 1849; prosecutions followed.
- German courts commuted sentences for those who agreed to leave for good. In Hesse, offenders “were released on condition that they depart for America.”
- Others fled to Switzerland, then one of only two republics in Europe.
- Under German and French pressure, the Swiss parliament **expelled 14 leaders** on 16 July 1849; 10 of them are in the sample.
- Swiss authorities often paid the ship fare at the port of departure.

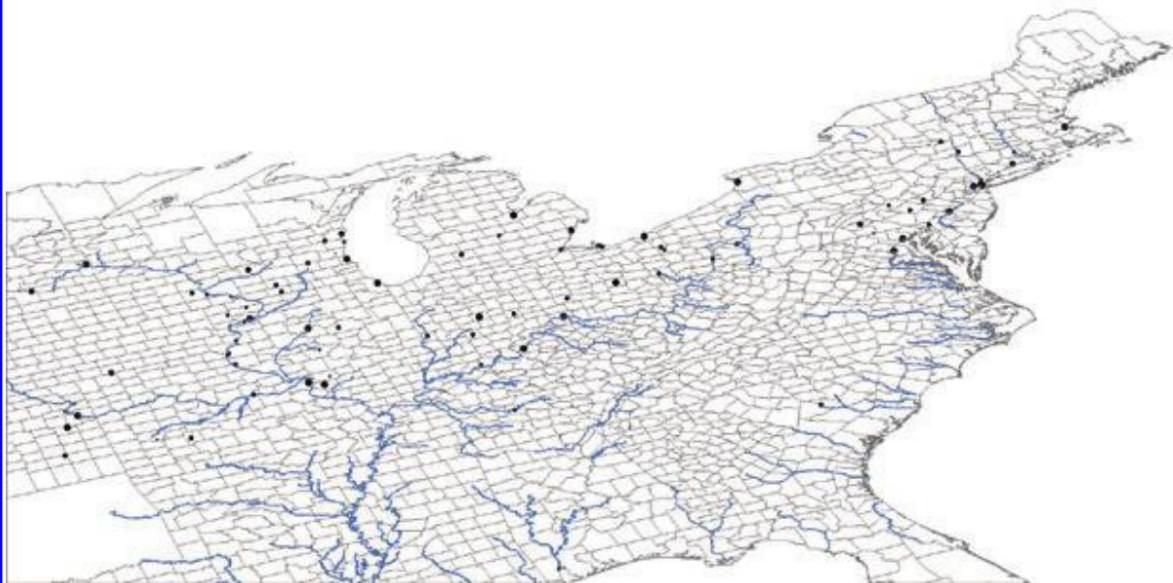


1854, and the argument they made

- Their first American years were politically quiet on slavery: the compromise of 1850 had settled the question for a while.
- The **Kansas-Nebraska Act of 1854** repealed the Missouri Compromise and put slavery back at the center.
- This led the Forty-Eighters to “revive the spirit of the failed struggle for liberty in the fight against slavery.”
- Friedrich Kapp, in the New York *Abendzeitung*: “It is the eternal conflict between a small privileged class and the great mass of the non-privileged, the eternal struggle between aristocracy and democracy.”
- Framed that way, emancipation traveled further than the moral abolitionism of the Second Great Awakening.

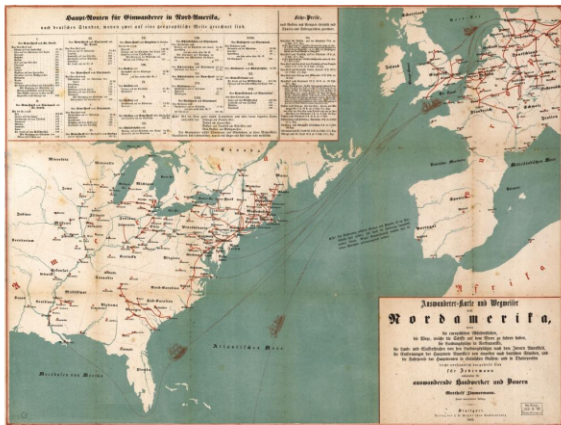
The data

- Almost 500 Forty-Eighter biographies, completed through genealogical sources: where each one settled.
- Town-level extracts of the 1850 and 1860 censuses, geolocated.
- The full Union Army registers, over 2 million men. For just under half of them the registers give county or state but no town, recovered by linking each soldier to the 1860 census by name, middle name and age.
- The registers give no origin either. A name-reading program trained on the census, where birthplace is known, gets it right in more than 90 percent of cases.
- A town is treated if at least one Forty-Eighter lived there **between 1856 and 1861**: 73 towns in the North.



Where they chose to live

- The central concern: if they settled where antislavery feeling was already rising, their effect is overstated.
- The biographies show what attracted them: less rural towns, the Midwest, existing German communities.
- First answer: compare each treated town with **statistical twins** in the same state.
- Matched sample: 54 Forty-Eighter towns against 207 look-alike controls, instead of 72 against 11,023.



Notes: The left panel shows the second edition of *Metzler's Auswanderer Karte*, published in 1853. The table in the top-left provides information on the distance and fare, red lines indicate the main travel routes, and red dots mark common destinations. The right panel shows our digitized version of Metzler's map along with the main routes and locations.

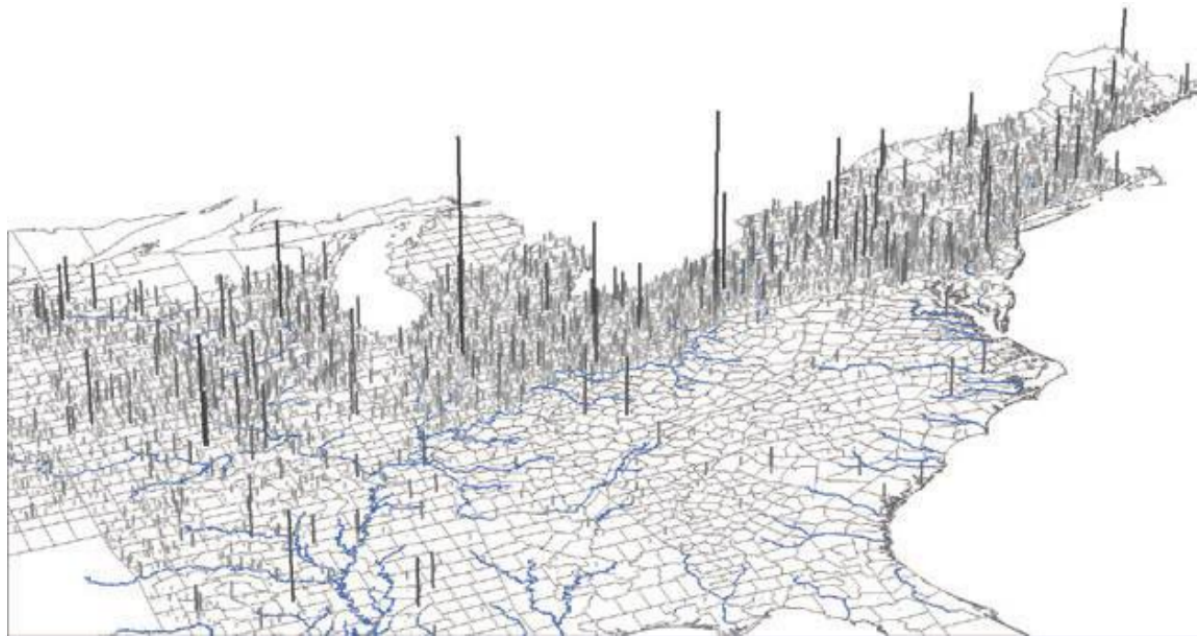
The ships

- Second answer: ties formed on the **transatlantic crossing**.
- They left in haste, mostly alone, with no planned destination. Only two stated one at the port.
- Six to ten weeks under cramped conditions, with time to learn where in America one might go.
- 152 Forty-Eighters located on 136 ships, out of more than 1,700 German immigrant voyages between 1848 and 1852.
- 46 percent settled in a town that a fellow passenger had named as their intended destination.

Results

Main result

- A town with at least one Forty-Eighter raised Union Army enlistments by **two-thirds**.
- About 8 extra enlistees per 100 adult men, against a median of 12 per 100.
- Without the twin towns the gap is about 90 percent: part of it came from where they chose to live.
- The ship-based estimates are no more than 10 points larger, and cannot be told apart from the rest.



The other German immigrants

- Other Germans arriving in the same window, 1848 to 1852, settled in similar places.
- Put side by side, only the **Forty-Eighters** move enlistments.
- Earlier and later arrival cohorts show nothing either.
- Reassigning their locations at random, 1,000 times, does not reproduce the result.

Mechanisms

Newspapers

- Many had been publicists and editors in Germany.
- Wittke: they “took control of the German newspapers, founded many new ones, and redirected public opinion.”
- Most **German-language papers were bilingual**, read by English speakers as well.
- Grant took pride that the Union Army was composed of men “who knew what they were fighting for,” because they read the papers.

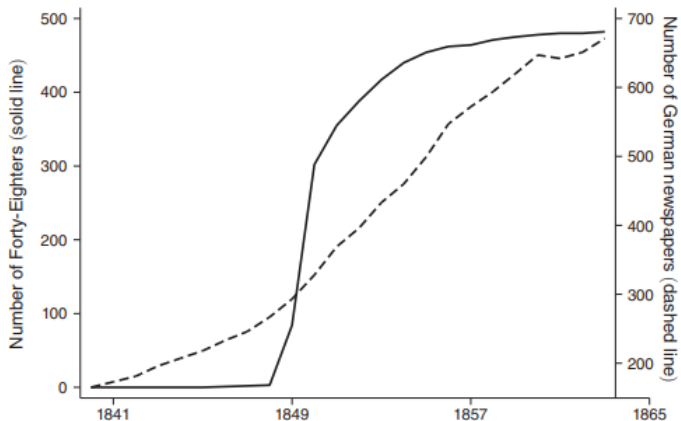
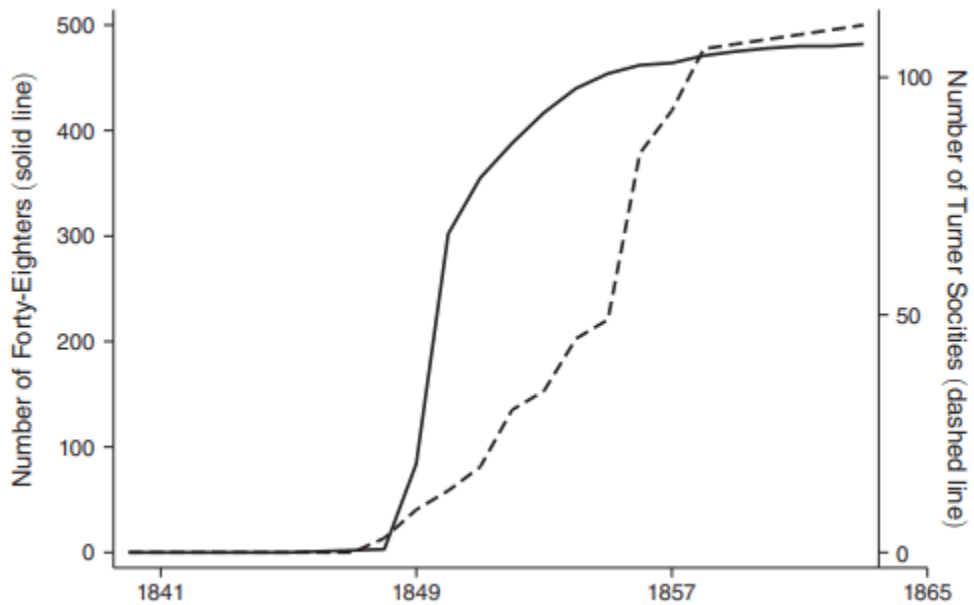


FIGURE 1. THE FORTY-EIGHTERS' ARRIVAL, GERMAN NEWSPAPERS, AND TURNER SOCIETIES

Notes: The top panel plots the arrival of the Forty-Eighters (solid line, scaled on the left axis) together with the emergence of the *Turner Societies* in the United States, the first two of which were founded in 1848 (dashed line, scaled on the right axis). The bottom panel plots the arrival of the Forty-Eighters (solid line, scaled on the left axis) together with the growth of German-language newspapers in the United States (dashed line, scaled on the right axis). The right scale starts at 165 German-language newspapers in 1840.

The Turner Societies

- Gymnastic clubs from the German states, politicized in the 1830s, vehicles of political organization in the 1848 revolutions.
- The first American **Turnverein** was founded in 1848; their number explodes after 1854.
- Their national convention had an abolitionist platform by 1855.
- Turners formed bodyguards for antislavery speakers, guarded Lincoln at his inauguration in 1860, and enlisted in blocks as “Turner Regiments.”
- Newspapers and clubs together account for about one-quarter of the effect on enlistments. The rest runs through channels that are harder to measure.



Speeches and their own enlistment

- These two channels turn on the timing of each act of leadership, so the authors read them as suggestive only.
- 27 newspaper reports of speeches, rallies and pro-Union events. Agitation was the era's tool: "the great and mighty instrument for carrying forward reforms."
- Enlistments rise about **60 percent** in the week of the event and the week after, then fall back.
- After a Forty-Eighter enlists himself: about 70 percent that week, 40 percent the next.
- Enlistment was a collective local event, so enthusiasm spread fast.

Figure A10: Effect of *Forty-Eighters'* civilian acts of leadership

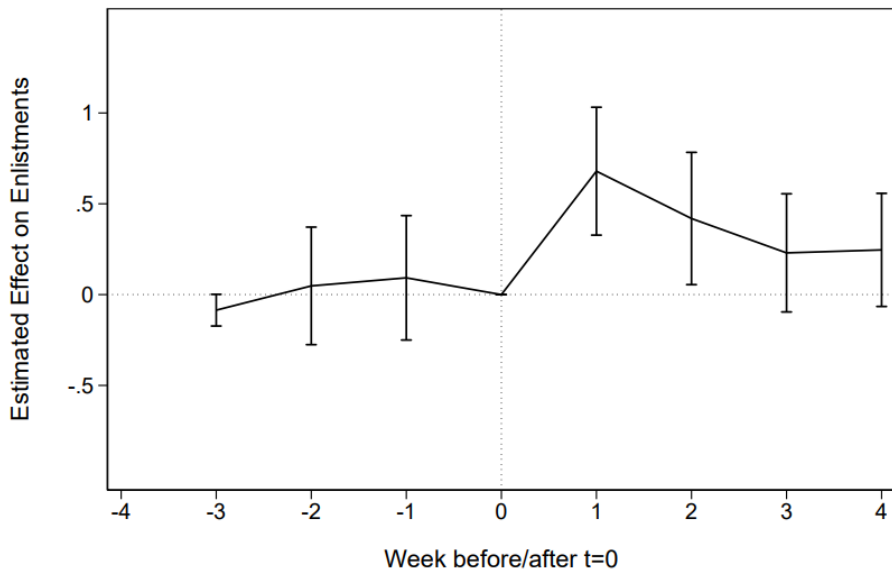
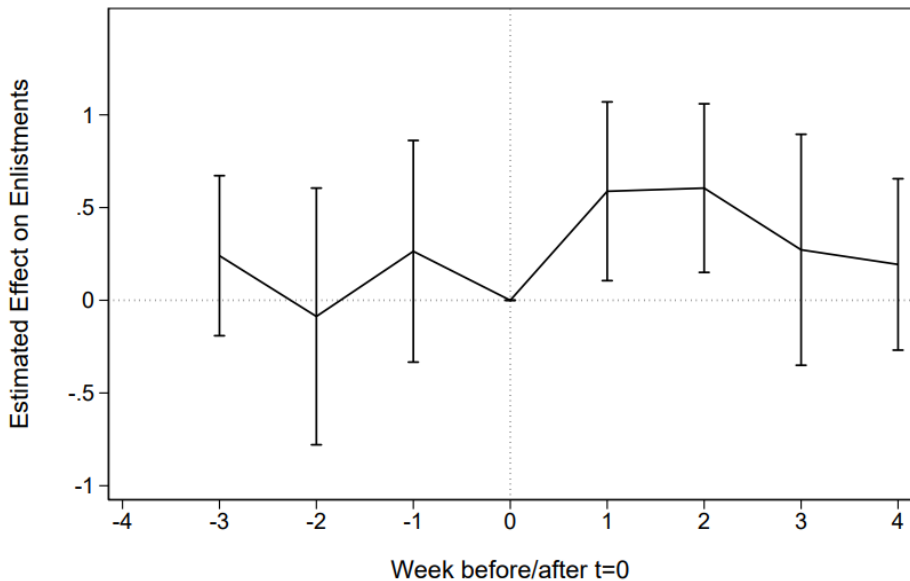


Figure A11: Effect of *Forty-Eighters'* own enlistments



In battle: desertion

- 149 Forty-Eighters enlisted. About one-third had military backgrounds in Germany; the rest were in their mid-forties or older, above the usual age.
- 22 commanded companies, 75 served as privates or lower-ranking officers.
- **Desertion** is read as an inverse measure of conviction. 8 percent of all soldiers deserted.
- Companies with a Forty-Eighter captain deserted about 30 percent less; with a Forty-Eighter private, about 17 percent less.

The long run: NAACP chapters

- An outcome chosen to post-date anything the Forty-Eighters themselves did.
- The first **NAACP** chapter was founded on 12 February 1909, timed to Lincoln's hundredth birthday.
- Forty-Eighter towns were 22 to 23 percent more likely to form a local chapter between 1909 and 1965.
- Read cautiously, as an indication of a lasting change in local norms.

What the authors take from it

- Leaders are identified by what they did in Germany, years before the American outcome.
- That sidesteps the usual problem: whether prominent people lead opinion or merely carry a banner that was rising anyway.
- Enlisting risked a man's life, so the response is not a matter of stated opinion.
- Against “great men” accounts built on Lincoln or Grant, the emphasis falls on **grassroots civic leadership**.

Heroes and villains

Cagé, Grosjean and Jha, *The Influence of Heroic Networks*;
Cagé, Dagorret, Grosjean and Jha (2023), *Heroes and Villains*, AER

6 February 1934

- Right-wing leagues marched on the Chamber of Deputies as a left-leaning cabinet was about to be seated.
- Among them, well-organized veterans' groups, including **decorated war heroes**.
- The police opened fire: 14 demonstrators killed, 236 wounded. The government fell a day later.
- Marcel Bucard, Verdun veteran and head of the Fascist Francisme party, in his journal that January: "We will set up the guillotines in the four corners of Paris and we will cut off heads."
- The chapter draws the parallel with Washington, DC, on 6 January 2021.

July 1940

- One of the most durable democracies in the world, 70 years old, voted away its own sovereignty.
- Full powers to **Maréchal Philippe Pétain**; the Third Republic ended.
- Unlike the Netherlands, Norway or Poland, France set up no government in exile and did not fight on from its empire.
- Pétain, 17 June 1940: “certain of the support of veterans that I am proud to have commanded, I give to France the gift of my person in order to alleviate her suffering.”

Heroes and Villains: The Effects of Heroism on Autocratic Values and Nazi Collaboration in France[†]

By JULIA CAGÉ, ANNA DAGORRET, PAULINE GROSJEAN, AND SAUMITRA JHA*

We measure how a network of heroes can legitimize and diffuse extreme political behaviors. We exploit newly declassified intelligence files, novel voting data, and regimental histories to show that home municipalities of French line regiments arbitrarily rotated under Philippe Pétain's generalship through the heroic World War I battlefield of Verdun diverge politically thereafter, particularly following Pétain's own overt espousal of authoritarian views. Further, under Pétain's collaborationist Vichy regime (1940–1944), they raise 7 percent more active Nazi collaborators per capita. These effects extend across all forms of Nazi collaboration and diffuse beyond the veterans themselves. (JEL D72, D74, N34, N44, Z13)

Frenchmen! ... I today assume the leadership of the government of France. Certain of the affection of our admirable army that has fought with a heroism worthy of its long military traditions ..., certain of the support of veterans that I am proud to have commanded, I give to France the gift of my person in order to alleviate her suffering.

—Maréchal Philippe Pétain, June 17, 1940

We speak with tenderness of the hero of Verdun: when giving us your life, your genius and your faith, you save the Fatherland a second time.

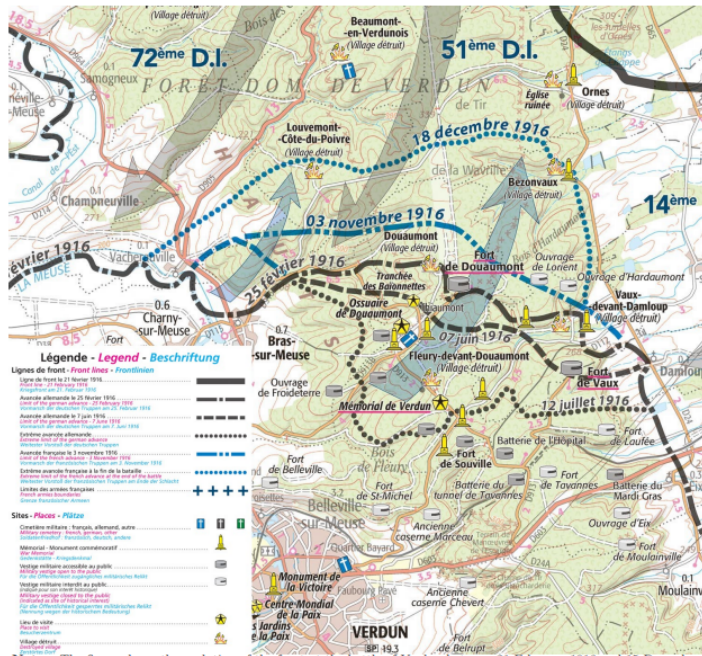
—André Dassary, in *Maréchal, nous voilà*, the unofficial anthem of Vichy, France, 1941

What the paper measures

- The effect of a **hierarchical network of heroes** on political behavior.
- Hierarchical: tied to one leader by a common experience of direct command. Heroic: sharing a credential of exemplary self-sacrifice.
- The network is created by the rotation of French regiments through Verdun under Pétain in 1916.
- The outcome is active collaboration with Nazi Germany under Vichy, 1940 to 1944.

The battle of Verdun, 1916

- 21 February 1916: after a concealed build-up, the Germans attack what had been a quiet sector.
- Fort Douaumont falls on 25 February; four generals are relieved within five days.
- A “snap decision” by the commander-in-chief Joffre puts Pétain in command on 26 February.
- Longest battle in history to that point. **305,440 soldiers killed**, almost a death a minute, February to December.



Map 1916 The Green shows the evolution of the front at the battle of Verdun between 21 February 1916 and 15 December 1916.

Pétain before Verdun

- Peasant background. Graduated 229 out of 386 from the Saint-Cyr military academy, and rose slowly.
- In 1914 a **58-year-old colonel** on the verge of retirement.
- No orator and no political networker; his superiors found him sarcastic, politicians found him cold.
- He got Verdun because he happened to be available: his army had been withdrawn from the front to prepare the Somme.

Ten weeks, then promoted away

- Pétain reorganized the single supply road, the Voie Sacrée, and rotated regiments through the front (the *noria*, or mill wheel).
- By 1 May, 53 percent of the entire French line infantry had done a tour at Verdun. Over 1916, **88 percent** of line regiments rotated through.
- Joffre promoted him away from direct command on 1 May; Nivelle took over. The battle ran until December.
- Daily deaths, artillery bombardment, German attacks and French counterattacks: unchanged around 1 May.

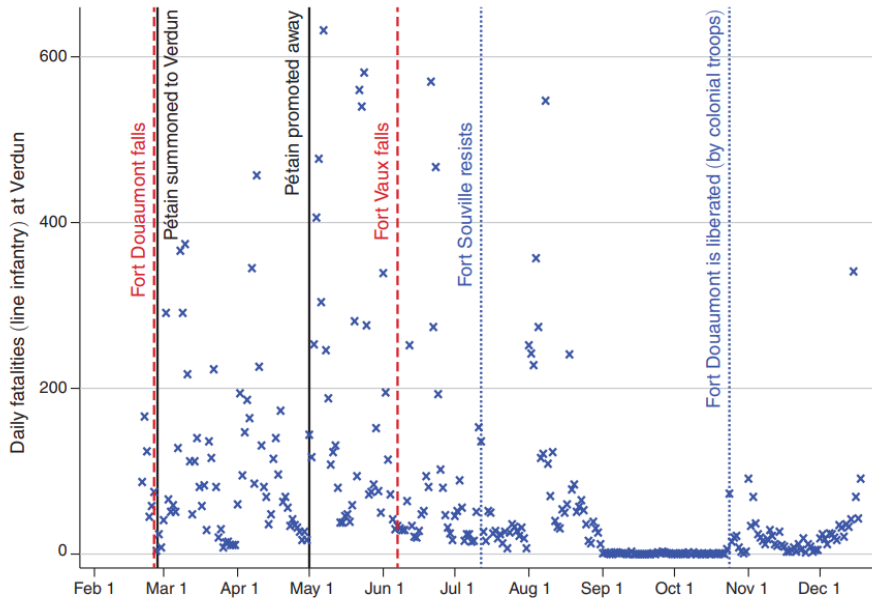
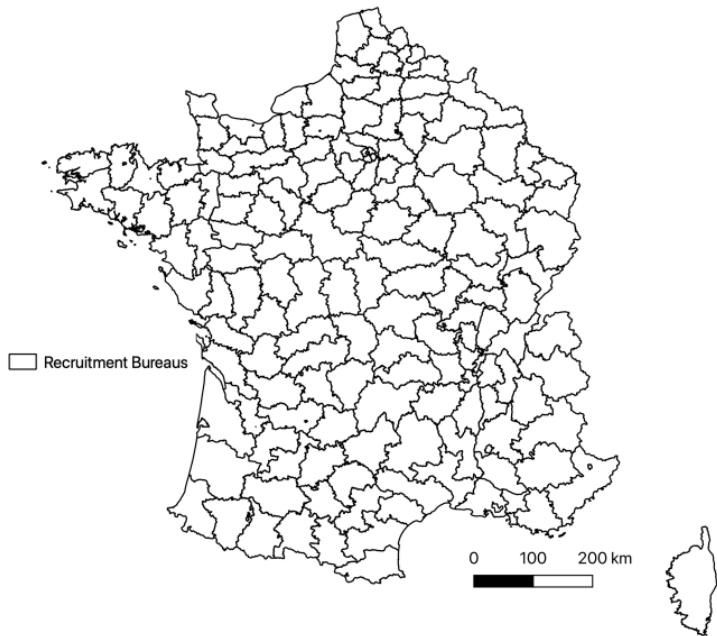


FIGURE 1. DAILY FRENCH FATALITIES OVER THE COURSE OF THE BATTLE OF VERDUN, 1916.

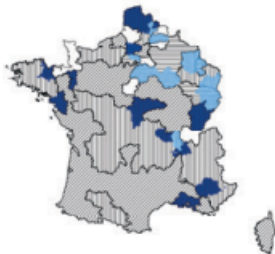
How the network is formed

- French line regiments were built to be **interchangeable** in training, equipment and strength, so they could be moved at will.
- Which regiment went to Verdun, and when, was Joffre's call, driven by the Somme agreement with the Allies and by German action.
- But to speed mobilization most regiments were raised in a fixed recruitment district, each with its own bureau and depot, so each of France's 34,947 municipalities maps to a regiment.
- A municipality is "Verdun under Pétain" if its regiment rotated through between 26 February and 1 May 1916.

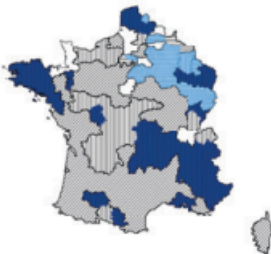




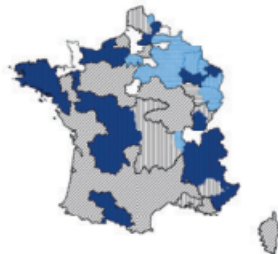
At Verdun in February



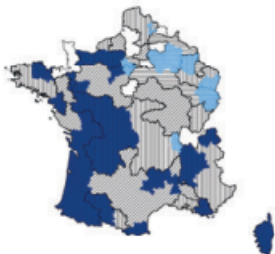
At Verdun in March



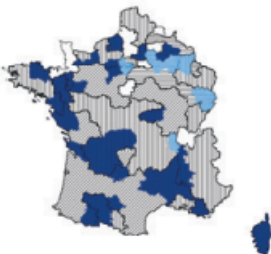
At Verdun in April



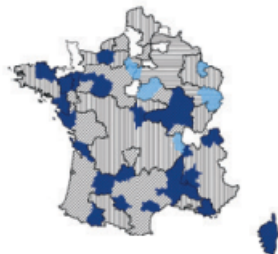
At Verdun in May



At Verdun in June



At Verdun in July



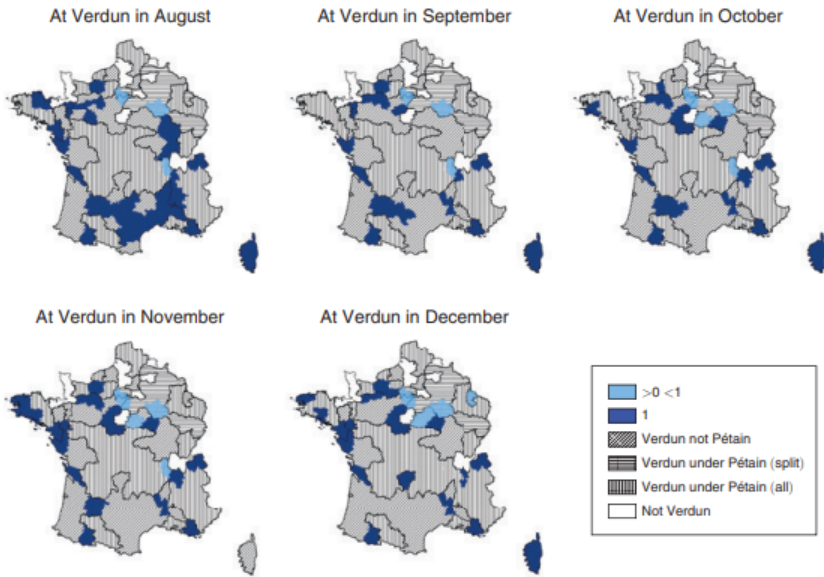


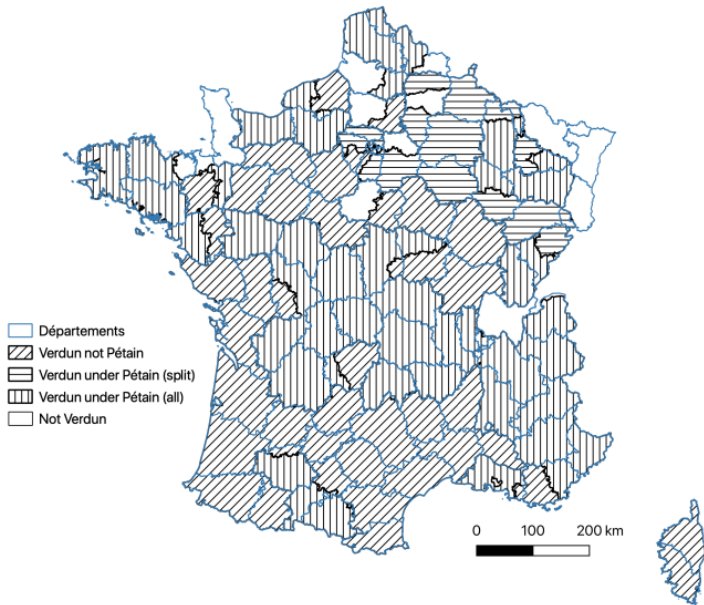
FIGURE 2. ROTATION OF REGIMENTS THROUGH VERDUN, BY MONTH, FEBRUARY–DECEMBER 1916

The comparison

- Municipalities in the same department whose regiments went to Verdun at different moments of 1916.
- Before the war the two groups look alike: same vote share for **every party in 1914**, from the Socialists (SFIO) to the parties of the right.
- Same population in 1911 and 1936, same distance to the demarcation line, same chance of ending up in occupied or in Vichy France.
- 3 of 63 characteristics examined differ at all, about what chance alone would produce.

Selection into the battle

- One worry: the first months were the worst, so those regiments were destroyed or scarred.
- The opposite worry: they came from favored places and were shielded from losses.
- Neither holds. By the end of the war, **fatality rates** in these municipalities are like everyone else's.
- France as a whole: the average municipality lost more than four percent of its population to military deaths.

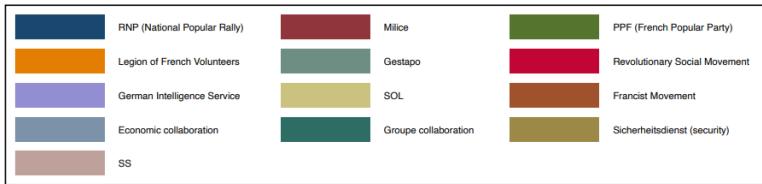
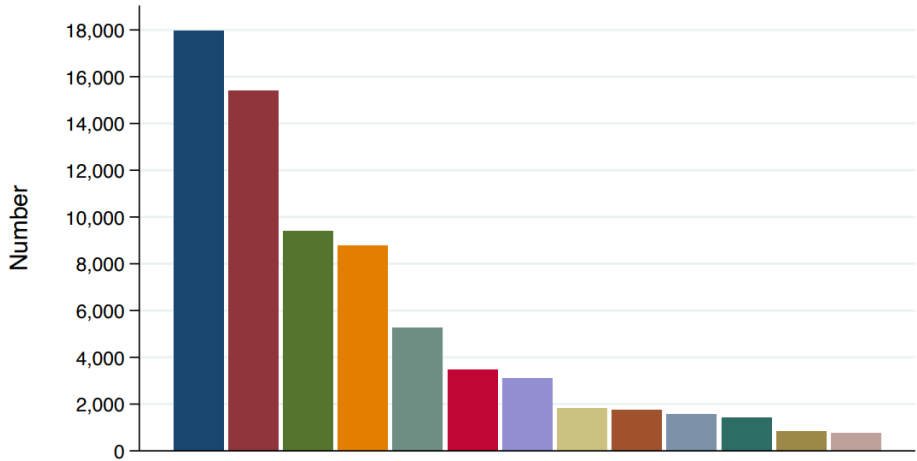


The collaborator file

- A 2,106-page list assembled in 1944 and 1945 under Colonel Paul Paillole, head of French army intelligence.
- 95,967 people named as active collaborators. The file disappeared twice after the war and was **declassified only in 2015**.
- Each entry: name, address, form of collaboration, sometimes age, birthplace and occupation.
- Digitized and georeferenced: 86,949 collaborators, 85,389 of them inside France's 1914 borders.

Forms of collaboration

- *Parties*: the RNP, founded in 1941 by former Socialists; the PPF, founded in 1936 by a former Communist.
- Leagues banned in 1936 and revived under Vichy: Bucard's Francisme, and the terrorist Cagoule as the MSR.
- *Paramilitaries*: the SOL from 1941, then the **Milice** from January 1943, hunting Jews and the Resistance.
- *Direct German service*: the Gestapo, the LVF on the Eastern Front, the Waffen-SS from July 1943. About 22,000 Frenchmen served in German units.



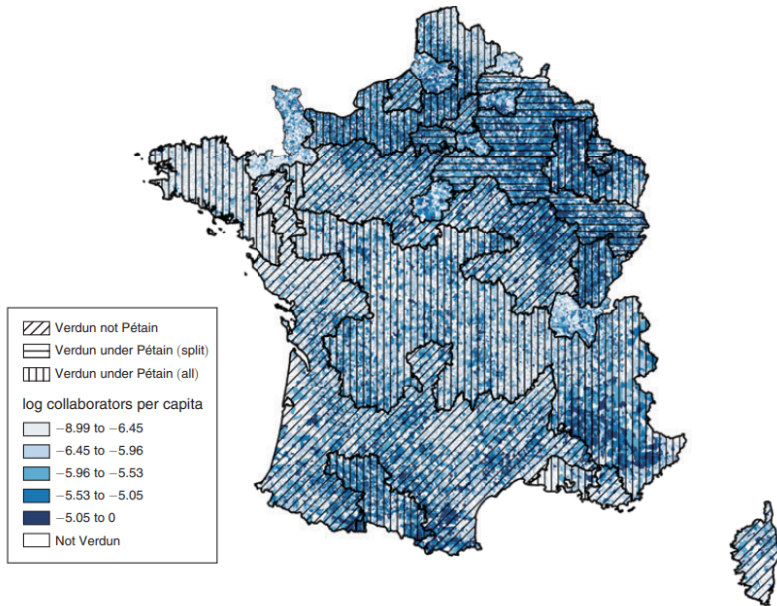


FIGURE 3. COLLABORATORS IN FRANCE, 1940–1945 (QUINTILES)

Results

Main result

- “Verdun under Pétain” municipalities raised **7 to 9 percent more collaborators** per head than otherwise similar municipalities in the same department.
- Raw counts: 9.91 collaborators per 10,000 people, against 7.81 where the regiment went to Verdun under another general.
- In absolute numbers, about 10,469 additional collaborators.
- Comparable to the 15,404 members of the Milice in the file, and almost twice the 5,276 who joined the Gestapo.

Combat as an explanation

- Local war deaths are, if anything, **negatively** related to later collaboration.
- Holding local fatality rates fixed leaves the result unchanged.
- No other two or three consecutive months at Verdun does the same, including December, when the battle was won.
- Passing through Verdun under a different general does not raise collaboration at all.

The voting data

- To follow the same places over time, the authors hand-collected municipal returns for 1914, 1919, 1924, 1932 and 1936.
- The 1914 results came from **paper archives**, more than 33,000 municipalities, digitized for the first time.
- The records list candidates, not parties: each one had to be identified and placed on a left to right scale.

RECENSEMENT
Extrait des procès-verbaux des

GÉNÉRAL DES VOTES.
opérations électorales de chaque commune.

MODÈLE N° 4 bis

CANTONS	COMMUNES	NOMBRE DES VOTANTS		NOMBRE DES VOTANTS		NOMBRE DES VOTANTS		NOMBRE DES VOTANTS		REMARKS
		MONTRE	FUTURES	MONTRE	FUTURES	MONTRE	FUTURES	MONTRE	FUTURES	
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	
Bassano	Angerville	71	48	49	49	-	2	41		
	Angerville	153	92	91	91		34	57		
	Angerville	156	153	153	153		19	159		
	Angerville	92	60	60	60		7	53		
	Angerville	11	11	11	11		-	15		
	Angerville	92	56	56	56		5	51		
	Angerville	15	13	13	13		5	10		
	Angerville	94	60	60	60		17	43		
	Angerville	150	92	92	92		12	80		
	Angerville	42	31	31	31		3	48		
	Angerville	117	85	85	85		18	57		
	Angerville	153	16	16	16		19	72		
	Angerville	75	51	50	50		9	51		
	Angerville	101	77	77	77		1	59		
	Angerville	110	74	74	74		14	50		
	Angerville	101	119	119	119		31	88		
	Angerville	59	30	30	30		6	24		
	Angerville	77	51	51	51		15	36		
	Angerville	111	60	60	60		16	49		
	Angerville	99	68	68	68		12	54		
Total		1904	1345	1345	1345		208	1077		

(1) Le présent tableau doit être complété par les communes qui ont des électeurs qui ne sont pas inscrits sur les listes de la loi du 17 juillet 1889.

NOMBRE DES SUFFRAGES OBTENUS PAR [X]										OBSERVATIONS
<i>Sabine</i>	<i>Savard</i>	<i>St. Jean Baptiste</i>	<i>St. Joseph</i>	<i>St. Louis</i>	<i>St. Michel</i>	<i>St. Pierre</i>	<i>St. Vincent</i>	<i>St. Xavier</i>	<i>St. Yves</i>	
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	
91	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
51	6	2	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	
112	15	7	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
37	19	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
12	1	-	-	2	-	-	-	-	-	
49	1	1	-	2	-	-	-	-	-	
10	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
40	2	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
58	13	7	-	2	-	-	-	-	-	
28	2	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
63	3	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
60	7	3	2	-	-	-	-	-	-	
45	3	1	1	1	-	-	-	-	-	
53	7	1	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	
41	9	4	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	
71	13	9	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
23	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
28	11	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
43	-	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	
47	6	2	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
915	107	43	6	6	-	-	-	-	-	

(2) Le présent tableau doit être complété par les communes qui ont des électeurs qui ne sont pas inscrits sur les listes de la loi du 17 juillet 1889.

Divergence between the wars

- Identical in 1914, these municipalities move right afterward, and do so as Pétain's own views move.
- Already in 1919: about **11 percent lower** vote for the left.
- 1919 and 1924: more votes for the Entente Républicaine Démocratique, a conservative right-wing party.
- 1936, first round: 7.7 percent more for the right, including 2.6 percent for Bucard's Francisme.
- Turnout is unaffected throughout.

Pétain between the wars

- Well known as an anti-Communist, with increasingly authoritarian sympathies after Verdun.
- Of 6.4 million French war veterans in 1920, about 3 million joined a **veterans' association**.
- He presided over the fund that built the Douaumont ossuary and spoke at the Verdun commemorations.
- In 1934 a right-wing newspaper ran a survey on who should lead France as its dictator. Pétain came first.

1 May 1936

- First round on 26 April, turnout 85 percent: the Popular Front takes more than 50 percent.
- Two days before the second round, Pétain gives a **front-page interview** to *Le Journal*, calling for a national rally.
- France “under threat” of socialism; Fascist Italy and Nazi Germany named as examples to follow; the Croix de Feu praised because they “occupy themselves with the moral and spiritual improvement of youth.”
- His biographer: “Far from being a soldier who would serve whatever government was legitimately elected, he had almost overnight openly associated himself with the political right.”

LE MOT D'ORDRE du maréchal Pétain :

Rassemblement national

— Monsieur, me dit le maréchal Pétain, je ne vois pas très bien ce que vous attendez de moi et je m'étonne même que les portes se soient ouvertes devant vous. Je me suis fait une règle absolue de ne jamais accorder d'interview et de ne pas faire de politique.

— Monsieur le maréchal, répondis-je, il n'est point question de politique. La *Revue des deux Mondes* s'appête à publier de vous un article sur la défense nationale et sur le commandement u n i q u e. J'aurais été heureux de vous poser quelques questions à ce sujet.

— Asseyez-vous. Je vous écoute.

— Vous dites dans cet article, monsieur le maréchal, que nous avons un ministre de la guerre, un ministre de la marine, un ministre de l'air...

— Mais que nous n'avons pas un ministre de la défense nationale, chargé de coordonner les efforts de ces trois départements et d'imprimer à tout cela une direction unique. Je dis cela pour le regretter. Il m'a semblé que le moment était venu d'aborder le problème, que demain il serait peut-être trop tard.



néfaste. Tout ce qui est national est utile et fécond. Les Croix de feu représentent l'un des éléments les plus sains de ce pays.

Ils veulent défendre la famille, lui garantir ses conditions indispensables d'existence. J'approuve cela. Tout part d'elle. La famille française a été expropriée, frappée de droits exorbitants. On dirait que nos législateurs n'ont eu d'autre but que de rompre la chaîne de l'effort et de décourager le père de travailler pour ses enfants. Je vois que les Croix de feu se préoccupent aussi du perfectionnement moral et spirituel de la jeunesse. Vous savez que c'est une idée qui est mienne depuis longtemps. *On ne peut rien faire d'une nation qui manque d'âme. C'est à nos instituteurs, à nos professeurs*

de la forger. Nous ne leur demandons pas de faire de nos enfants des savants. Nous leur demandons d'en faire des hommes et des Français.

— Monsieur le maréchal, le peuple français est allé voter dimanche dernier et il y retournera dimanche prochain. J'aurais voulu recueillir votre mot d'ordre.

One week, seven points

- The two rounds were held one week apart.
- In “Verdun under Pétain” municipalities the Socialist vote fell by **about 7 points** between the rounds.
- Almost exactly the same amount went to the right-wing Alliance Démocratique.
- Its leader, Pierre-Étienne Flandin, would serve Pétain at Vichy as vice-president and foreign minister.
- Turnout did not move.

Mechanisms

Why trust Pétain

- His headquarters and his sleeping quarters sat on the Voie Sacrée itself, “closer to the battle than many generals of his day would have thought necessary, or comfortable.”
- He stood on the steps of the town hall to see and be seen, and visited hospitals from which other commanders recoiled.
- Regimental journals of units under his direct command mention him **29.2 percent more** than other Verdun regiments.
- With the battle unchanged, his men shared in the credit: 14.8 percent more citations for valor than later Verdun regiments, 23.8 percent more than regiments serving elsewhere.

From trust to loyalty

- 23,431 collaborators in the file have age and sex recorded.
- Men born between 1890 and 1898 were of age for line infantry conscription in the First World War.
- Among these **likely veterans**, “Verdun under Pétain” municipalities raised about 6 percent more collaborators.
- Troops Pétain commanded before Verdun show a smaller effect, about 2 to 3 percent.

Diffusion beyond the veterans

- Collaboration also rises among people who cannot have served in the line infantry: too young, too old, or women.
- About **7 percent more**, and only in “Verdun under Pétain” municipalities.
- Where Pétain commanded before Verdun, without the heroic credential, there is no spillover to non-veterans.
- Both parts appear to be needed: the tie to the leader, and the veterans’ own standing as heroes of Verdun.

Other heroic networks

- Maréchal **Foch**, the other great hero of the war, whose interwar sympathies echoed Pétain's: no effect on collaboration.
- Other celebrated battles, the Marne that saved Paris and the Somme: no effect.
- Verdun under Nivelle, including the recapture of Fort Douaumont: no effect.
- What operates is the network formed under Pétain's direct command, not heroism in general.

Persistence and escalation

- The effect appears across every form of collaboration: parties, paramilitaries, German units, economic dealings.
- Organizations born in the 1930s and reconstituted under Vichy gain about **5 to 6 percent** more members.
- Still there for the Milice, formed in January 1943, and the Waffen-SS, open to Frenchmen from July 1943, when Germany was clearly losing and joining was dangerous.
- Each member's credential is worth more while the others, above all Pétain, are still counted as heroes. Hence the incentive to keep investing, and the cost of walking away.

Bucard and Darnand

- Both decorated for heroism by Pétain himself, both later inducted into the Legion of Honor.
- Both strongly anti-German; both rejoined the army and won further recognition fighting Germany in 1939 and 1940.
- Both then followed Pétain into collaboration: Bucard co-founded the LVF, Darnand founded the SOL and, at Pétain's personal request, led the Milice.
- Darnand swore allegiance to Hitler and joined the Waffen-SS. **Executed in 1945;** Bucard in 1946.
- Darnand to De Gaulle on the eve of his execution: his men's "only mistake is to have been faithful to a great soldier."

Alternative explanations

- Violence begetting violence: the effect is not concentrated in the violent organizations, and resistance membership moves the other way.
- Patronage and money: the effect is not concentrated in economic collaboration, and it shows up in **secret ballots** years before Pétain held power.
- Occupation geography: these municipalities were no closer to the demarcation line and no more likely to be occupied.
- Each may play a complementary role. None accounts for the pattern on its own.

The other side: the Resistance

- A companion paper uses more than 425,966 recognized participants in the French **Resistance**.
- “Verdun under Pétain” municipalities raised 8.45 percent fewer members of the civilian resistance.
- Resistance is not simply the mirror image of collaboration: most French people did neither, and some did both in turn.

October 1951

- De Gaulle, who had served under Pétain in the First World War, commuted his death sentence to life imprisonment.
- Pétain died in prison in July 1951. His death set off demonstrations in most French cities, organized by **veterans of Verdun**.
- A mass in Notre Dame that October drew about five thousand people and ended in a riot.
- Associated Press: “Old heroes of Verdun carried their flags, carefully rolled, into the church to honor the man who once commanded them.”

The chapter's closing case

- Maine, 1880. An armed crowd gathers at the State House, mobilized by claims of a rigged election.
- **Joshua Chamberlain**, who had held Little Round Top at Gettysburg with the 20th Maine, walks up the steps unarmed and alone.
- “I am here to preserve the peace and honor of this State, until the rightful government is seated.”
- A veteran pushes to the front to defend him, and the crowd melts away.
- The same credential, used to hold a contested election in place.

Takeaway

- Costly sacrifice is a **credential**: a signal that a person will put the nation ahead of private interest.
- That lets a hero endorse positions which, from anyone else, would be read as self-interested or beyond the pale.
- A network of people sharing the credential amplifies the endorsement and makes reversal costly for each member.
- Heroic networks can carry democratic values and peace as readily as authoritarian ones.

For discussion: Brazil

- Brazil's **Expeditionary Force** fought in Italy in 1944 and 1945 and came home with combat credentials of its own.
- Humberto Castelo Branco served on its staff there and became the first president of the military government in 1964.
- Veterans' associations sit at the center of the same kind of network, with the same claim to have sacrificed for the nation.
- Does the mechanism travel? What would you need to measure to find out?